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On day small boat migrants this year hit **25,000** in record time

PROOF STARMER'S SMASH THE GANGS CAMPAIGN'S A JOKE

WEDNESDAY'S ARRIVALS: 898

By Rory Tingle
and Harriet Line

KEIR Starmer's pledge to 'smash the gangs' was in tatters last night after a new record was set for Channel crossings.

More than 25,000 migrants have now arrived in the UK in small boats this year, the earliest that this milestone has been reached.

Nearly 900 arrived in Dover from northern France on Wednesday, bringing the total for 2025 so far to 25,436, Home Office figures show.

The record number, which represents a rise of more than 50 per cent on 2024, prompted demands yesterday for Labour to declare a 'national emergency'.

One of the Prime Minister's first acts after winning power was to scrap the Conservatives'

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